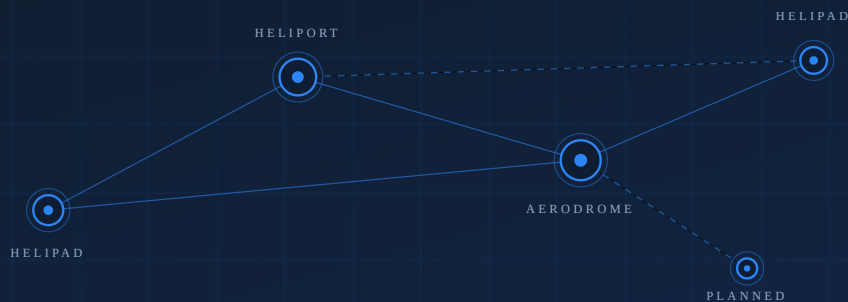


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02



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The Network Platform

The core asset: a graph of helipads, heliports and routes, the aircraft fleet, and an operator-neutral scheduling and availability engine covering the full span of aviation activities.

IN THIS SECTION

Sites and routes form a graph

Every helipad, heliport and aerodrome is a node; every route is sellable inventory.

One engine, every activity

Tours, charters, transfers, medevac and ferry run on the same scheduling core.

Operations run themselves

Availability, crews, disruptions and schedules are computed continuously.

Built to compound

Each new node raises the value of every existing node on the network.

The Network Platform

Working title: Andaman Aerodrome Network Platform (**AANP**). The name designates the core, operator-neutral layer of the system; it is a working title and can be re-branded without any technical change.

§ What the platform fundamentally is

AANP is the **digital operating system for a network of helipads, heliports and aircraft**. It is not a booking website with a flight database attached — it is the inverse: a complete aviation network management core, on top of which commercial products (tours, charters, transfers) are merely one category of consumer.

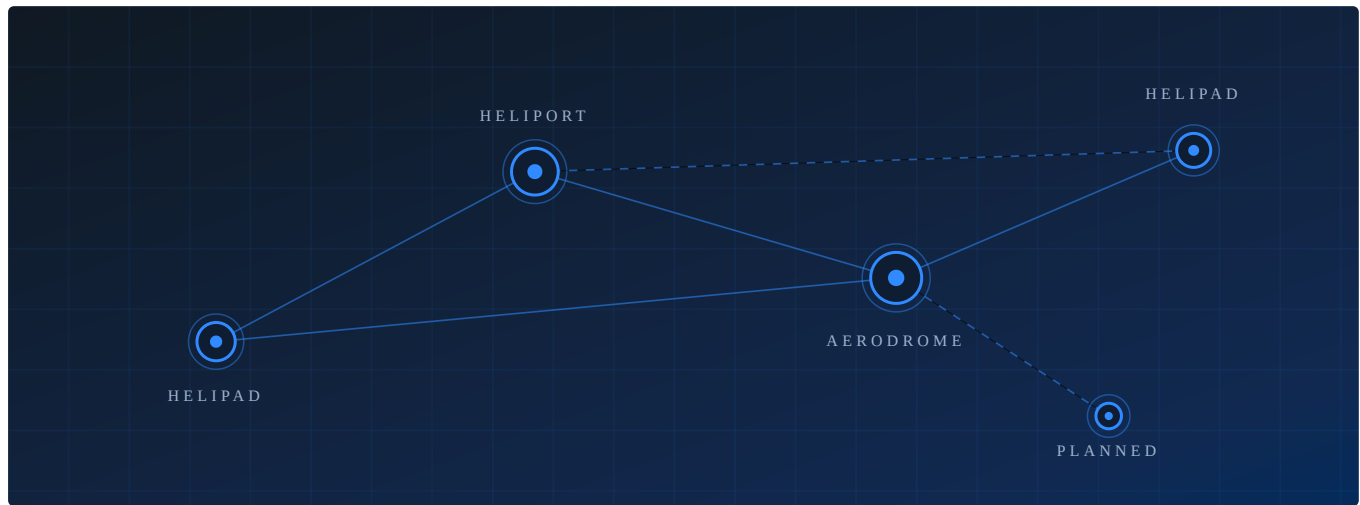
Everything an organization needs to **own, operate and expand a vertical-flight network** is a first-class citizen of the data model:

NETWORK CAPABILITY	PLATFORM IMPLEMENTATION
Helipads / heliports / airfields	<code>airfields</code> — location, timezone, contact, metadata
Route network between sites	<code>airfield_network_edges</code> — distance, flight time per leg
Aircraft fleet	<code>aircraft</code> — registration, model, capacity, default crew/components
Fleet maintenance & service log	<code>aircraft_events</code> , <code>aircraft_components</code>
Route planning	<code>flight_plans</code> — departure/arrival airfield, waypoints, duration
Work orders for any aviation activity	<code>missions</code> — typed: tour, charter, transfer, medevac, ferry
Scheduled operations	<code>flights</code> — aircraft, status lifecycle, departure time
Crew management	<code>flight_crew</code> — pilots, co-pilots, engineers, medics per flight
Flight logistics	<code>flight_components</code> — catering, ground transport, equipment
Network-wide disruptions	<code>operational_events</code> — maintenance, weather, crew rest, inspections

All of these live in the production database of `silkskyair-api` today (migrations `20251230300*` onward), protected by dedicated access privileges (`module:network:*` , `module:scheduling:*`) that separate network operations from every commercial concern.

§ The network is the graph; everything else follows

The model is deliberately graph-shaped: **airfields are nodes**, **network edges are routes**, and every flight the platform ever schedules is derived from that graph.



Sites become nodes

Every helipad, heliport and aerodrome joins the graph with its routes, timezone and operating data.

Routes become inventory

Each connection carries distance and flight time — the raw material of every product sold on the network.

Schedules compute themselves

Missions, crews, ferry legs and disruptions are resolved into flyable schedules automatically.

Adding a heliport to the network is a data operation, not a software project.

The consequence for expansion is structural: a new node plus its edges immediately participates in route planning, scheduling, availability and every commercial product downstream.

§ The scheduling and availability engine

The platform continuously answers the hardest operational question in vertical flight — *"which aircraft can be where, when, with whom on board?"* — automatically:

- **scheduler_rebuild** recomputes every aircraft's schedule (missions, ferry legs, returns, maintenance windows) for a time window. It runs nightly via **pg_cron** and is re-triggered immediately when bookings, network edges or maintenance events change.
- **Availability computation** enforces operational rules in real time: operational-event blackouts (per aircraft, per airfield, per crew member), booking cutoffs, join-flight cutoffs for shared flights, and seat-capacity checks — before any commercial logic runs.

- **A dedicated cache layer** (`cache` schema: month calendars, per-date slots) keeps availability queries fast at consumer-traffic volumes, with automatic invalidation when operational or pricing data changes.

This engine is operator-neutral. It schedules *missions* — a tour for a commercial brand, a medevac, a ferry flight and a private charter are the same kind of object to the core. That neutrality is what makes the platform a **turn-key solution for aviation activities** in general, rather than a tour-sales system.

§ Mission types: the full span of aviation activities

`mission_types` is an open taxonomy. The platform ships with:

TYPE	ACTIVITY
<code>tour</code>	Scheduled sightseeing products (the SilkSkyAir showcase — see case study)
<code>charter</code>	Private on-demand flights
<code>transfer</code>	Point-to-point passenger transport between network nodes
<code>medevac</code>	Medical evacuation operations
<code>ferry</code>	Repositioning flights, automatically planned by the scheduler

New activity types (cargo, survey, training, agricultural work) are additive rows, not new modules — the scheduling, crew, maintenance and disruption machinery applies unchanged.

§ Operational integrity by design

- **Event-sourced records** — operational state changes append events rather than overwrite rows, producing a complete audit trail (see Platform Asset Value for the compliance argument).
- **Role-segregated access** — network and scheduling functions are guarded by database-enforced privileges (`rls_has_privilege('module:scheduling:manage')` and related policies), so commercial users can never touch operational data.
- **Disruption handling as data** — an `operational_event` with a scope (aircraft, airfield or crew member) instantly and consistently blocks availability across every commercial channel, with no coordination required between teams.

§ Why this layer is the company's primary asset

1. **It encodes the physical network.** The helipads, heliports, routes and aircraft — the assets new management intends to own, expand and operate — have a one-to-one digital representation that is already running in production.

2. **It is activity-agnostic.** Tours are one of five mission types. The same core can operate transfers, medevac and charter businesses the day they are commercially relevant.
3. **It compounds.** Every node added to the graph increases the value of every other node (more routes, more products, more utilization options) — the classic network effect, captured in a schema built for it.
4. **It is separable.** The commercial features documented in the next chapter sit *on top of* this layer and can be white-labelled to any number of operators — see White-Label Separation.